

TALIA BALOGUN

CREATIVE MARKETING & CAMPAIGN STRATEGY

Entertainment & Brand Campaigns | Creative Direction | Audience & Positioning Strategy

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Creative marketing and campaign strategist with 3+ years directing creative decisions inside entertainment, fashion, and institutional campaigns in the US, UK, and Nigeria — from audience research and pitch positioning through hands-on creative direction of photo, video, and campaign output. Direct experience includes marketing and pitch strategy work on Disney's *Iwájú*, brand partnership management with Nike and other major partners, and directing full creative teams across print, photography, and video for live campaigns. Comfortable moving between big-picture positioning and on-the-ground execution, with a long-term goal of moving from campaign-level creative direction into entertainment marketing strategy and development.

EXPERIENCE

Marketing & Strategy Intern — Kugali Media

Sept 2024 – June 2025 | UK / Hybrid

*Kugali Media is a global animation studio behind Disney's *Iwájú*; Talia supported the marketing and pitch strategy team across the studio's slate.*

- Supported festival and awards-season promotion and on-the-ground coverage for Disney's *Iwájú*, including the Emmys and NAACP Image Awards, gathering competitive and industry intelligence to inform brand positioning.
- Built producer-facing pitch decks and led streaming and studio partnership research and positioning for *Jollof Wars* (selected for Next Narrative Africa Fund's inaugural development slate) and *Razorman* (in development with Newmation and Alta Global Media).
- Reviewed 50+ scripts and comics weekly, providing research-backed creative and strategic notes that informed brand positioning and pitch direction across the release pipeline.
- Managed marketing operations and CRM data through HubSpot, supporting administrative coordination across concurrent projects.

Director of Creative Media — FAST@UCLA

Oct 2024 – June 2026 | Los Angeles, CA

FAST is a UCLA student-run fashion and culture organization operating as a revenue-generating brand, with paid partnerships, an annual publication, and an annual fashion show. Talia directed all creative media output — print, photography, video, and media releases — working closely with the marketing lead and production members.

- Directed all creative media production — print, photography, video, and media releases — across editorial, digital, and live-event initiatives, overseeing a full team of photographers, videographers, and designers on every shoot and release.
- Set creative direction and final sign-off on all visual output for FAST's annual fashion show and publication, translating brand and partnership priorities into concrete creative decisions across every format.
- Served as key creative point of contact for brand partners including Nike, Icona Club, and Demonía, developing creative briefs and directing partner-facing photo and video content while maintaining brand standards across activations.
- Managed and directed a team of designers, photographers, videographers, and writers across concurrent shoots and releases, reviewing results after each initiative to refine creative process and output.
- Co-led planning and creative execution of FAST's annual fashion show, overseeing all on-site photo and video coverage from concept through final delivery.

Creative Director (Contract) — Live Nation

Mar 2025 – June 2025 | NYC / Hybrid

Commissioned to direct and produce the official promotional film and live concert projection content for Mutha Festival, a live entertainment event in Brooklyn.

- Directed creative strategy and produced the official promotional film and live concert projection content, translating brand vision and cultural positioning into a cohesive visual direction across digital and live touchpoints.
- Managed creative asset delivery, versions, and approvals across teams and vendors, building production schedules to meet tight event deadlines.
- Served as the central point of coordination between creative, production, and promotional teams from planning through same-day execution.
- Maintained brand and creative consistency across the festival's digital and live touchpoints, tracking feedback and revisions through final delivery.

Media Marketing Coordinator — UCLA Student Affairs

June 2023 – Sept 2025 | Los Angeles, CA

- Directed creative and campaign strategy for multi-platform institutional content across Instagram, TikTok, Facebook, and X, translating campus priorities into brand-consistent creative direction for an audience of 2M+.
- Built and maintained campaign trackers and performance reporting, using engagement data to inform creative and positioning decisions.
- Coordinated cross-departmental campaigns and stakeholder communication for large-scale institutional events, including commencement.
- Captured and edited on-site content in real time during major university events, functioning as a live point of contact for content needs.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Marketing Strategy Intern — FCMB Group

Apr 2026 – June 2026 |

- Spearheaded initial campaign research into youth acquisition and attractive banking features for Flexx, FCMB's youth banking product, informing a strategic positioning deck ("Stronger Together").
- Contributed to a three-part growth strategy spanning savings-behavior gamification, campus-based creator funding, and salary lifecycle conversion, translating research into a go-to-market and content strategy across TikTok, campus activations, and creator partnerships.
- Supported development of a KPI framework and phased execution roadmap to track acquisition, engagement, and retention outcomes against the campaign's strategic goals.

Marketing Coordinator, Creative & Strategy — Refine LA

Sept 2023 – June 2025 | Los Angeles, CA

- Directed editorial cover shoots and magazine promotion videos as creative lead, managing concept through execution for a sustainability-focused fashion and circular retail organization.
- Coordinated multi-platform marketing campaigns and event promotion, including initiatives sponsored by Poshmark and Eyewear.
- Defined visual language and production processes to keep creative output consistent across live events, digital promotion, and editorial materials.
- Mentored contributors across photography, design, and media teams, aligning creative output with brand strategy.

Founder — Co Curate

July 2026 – Present |

- Building an independent creative studio operating with a managed, on-call curator roster — assignments are made by the studio rather than browsed by clients directly.
- Developing an IP origination model spanning curator-pitched projects, independent director co-productions, and workforce access for funded productions.
- Focusing initial go-to-market on entertainment and animation-adjacent marketing, leveraging existing UCLA and Kugali network relationships ahead of expanding into brand and corporate marketing.

Writer, Producer & Director — Ctrl 4C (Independent Animated Short Film)

2025 – Present | Los Angeles, CA

- Writing and directing an original animated short — a sci-fi comedy set in a Lagos salon — following a character who accidentally time-travels through a hair-tech invention into a frozen '90s sitcom world.
- Producing the project end-to-end: managing production timeline, budget, and a festival distribution and positioning strategy targeting Sundance, GLAS Animation, Manchester Animation Festival, Carmel International, Film Africa London, and AFRIFF.
- Designed poster and key art for festival submission materials, translating the film's visual world into a single promotional image.

Marketing Director — Black Film and Theatre Initiative

Sept 2025 – June 2026 |

- Directed promotional strategy and creative materials for the organization's festivals, workshops, and short-film fundraising initiatives.

Writers Room Coordinator — Bap Production

Jun – Sept 2023 | Lagos, Nigeria

- Reviewed scripts and treatments, supporting story development for Netflix-commissioned and in-house film/TV projects.
- Participated in writers' room sessions supporting sequel development (Bling Lagosians 2) and cross-departmental narrative continuity.

Production Assistant — Golden Effects Pictures Ltd

Apr 2020 – May 2021 | Lagos, Nigeria

- Provided administrative and production support during pre-production at a Lagos-based production company.

PR Event Coordinator — Jewel by Lisa

Oct – Nov 2020 | Lagos / London

- Supported fashion designer Lisa Folawiyo ahead of Lagos and London Fashion Week, managing models and runway shows.

CORE SKILLS

Strategy & Direction: Brand & Campaign Strategy • Creative Direction & Decision-Making • Audience & Market Research • Positioning & Pitch Development

Partnerships & Coordination: Brand Partnership Management • Cross-Functional & Creative Team Leadership • Presentation & Stakeholder Communication

Content & Delivery: Campaign Coordination & Delivery • Content & Visual Direction • Performance Reporting • Fast-Paced, Multi-Project Execution

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, Premiere Pro, After Effects, InDesign) • HubSpot CRM • Google Workspace • Microsoft Office • Canva • Notion • Asana • Airtable

EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles — B.A., Film & Television (Animation Concentration), Entrepreneurship Minor | 2022–2026
Cheltenham Ladies' College (UK) — GCSE & A-Level: English, Economics, Fine Art, EPQ in Animation | 2017–2022